

Tow Leader & Operator Info Pack 2026

This list is a guide only and is not exhaustive. In no way do we suggest that you should be doing all these things on your own, but rather that you need to ensure that these things are done.

DELEGATION is critical for a Tow Leader. Ask questions if unsure.

Tow Leaders – overview

In cases where there are sufficient trained people, every non-Venturer Winter Party has a single (1) Tow Leader to ensure we remain compliant with the Rope Tow standards. This role is not an additional NOBS position, rather a separate role. In some circumstances a Tow Leader may also be a NOB.

If your Winter Party does not have a nominated tow leader, the Rover Chalet Rope tow MUST NOT be used.

The Tow Leader utilises the experience of their party, designating Tow Operators and Tow Supervisors from those in their party to do so each day/pre-determined period.

All Tow Operators may provisionally upskill competent party members, as long as they meet requirements as outlined in the *BRC Rope Tow Training Program document*.

Running of the tow is subject to snow conditions and trained personnel.

Prior to your week

1. Attend the Tow Leaders & Tow Operators Briefing (or watch the recording).
2. You will be sent a list of party members and their current training level, as well as each participant's self identified level as they've noted during their booking process.
3. Rewatch the "how to use the nutcracker video". Link [here](#).
4. Read:
 1. BRC Rope Tow Activity Plan
 2. BRC Tow Leader Info Pack
 3. BRC Rope Tow Training Program
 4. BRC Rope Tow SOPs

Role during your week

Location of documentation

Available online [HERE](#) (this is under our Safety Guidelines, Risk Assessments & Activity Plans) <https://tinyurl.com/BRCRiskAssessmentsETC>

Available at the Chalet in the two labelled folders. One folder at the tow hut, the other underneath the phone in the dining room.

Requirements prior to the first use of the tow for the week

- A. Tow Briefing for ALL participants
- B. Safety & maintenance

A. Tow Briefing for ALL participants

Prior to the first operation of the BRC Rope Tow, the Tow Briefing must be done with the whole party present. As such, we recommend that this be done after morning duties. This briefing can be done by the Tow Leader with the support of Trained Tow Operators. The Tow Leader however must ensure that this gets completed in its entirety.

The Briefing and its contents is accessible from either the Rope Tow folder in the Chalet or in the Tow Hut, in the document titled "*BRC Rope Tow Training Program*". It covers points including but not limited to:

- Safety
- Critical technical nuances
- Training
- Roles of participants in Rope Tow operations

You must cover the briefing provided in the BRC Rope Tow Training Program document.

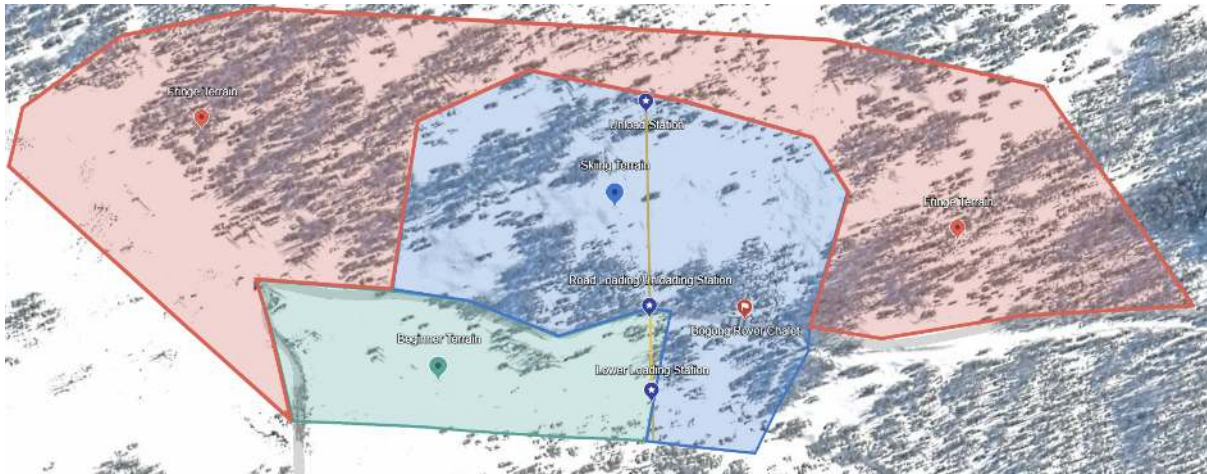
Tow Training Hierarchy

At-a-glance  Refer to *BRC Rope Tow Training Program* document



The Tow Training Hierarchy has changed in 2026 so please take time to review the *BRC Rope Tow Training Program* document.

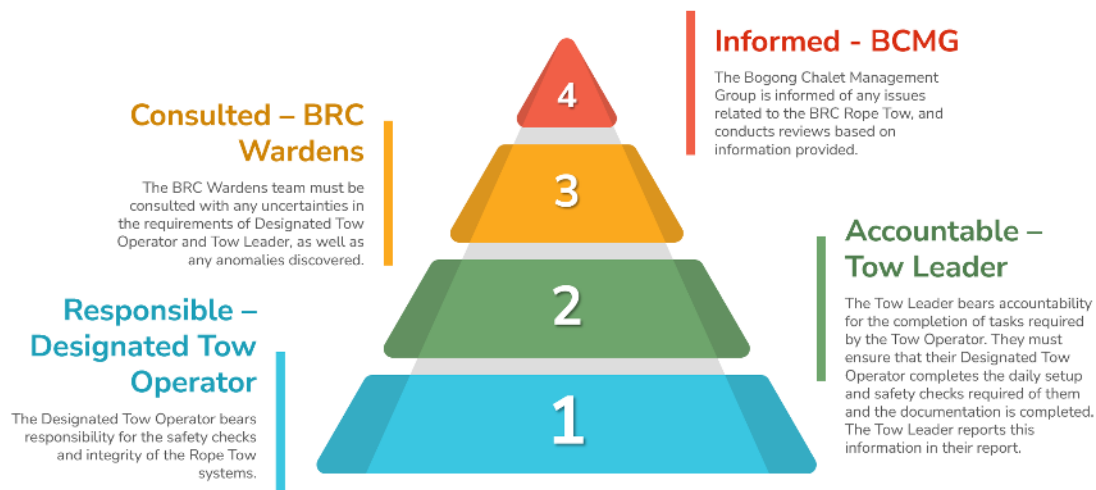
Terrain map



The sections marked in green on this map are considered “easier” skiing and the sections marked in blue are considered “more challenging”. The sections marked in red are also considered “more challenging”, but Tow Operators must ensure that when skiing in this Fringe Terrain is occurring, there is a minimum of 4 tow riders and the buddy system is being used. The above further applies to areas outside the bounds of the activity area, marked colourless, where a Trip Intention Form must also be completed.

B. Safety & Maintenance

Hierarchy of Responsibility



BRC Rope Tow Operations utilise the above Hierarchy of Responsibility. Tow Leaders designate responsibility to Designated Tow Operators each day/operating period, who hold responsibility for safety and integrity checks as well as operational requirements. Tow Leaders are then accountable in ensuring their Designated Tow Operator completes the tasks they are responsible for. The BRC Wardens team must be consulted by the

Designated Tow Operator and Tow Leader when uncertainty exists. The BCMG must be informed of any issues in BRC Rope Tow systems, procedures and incidents, who then must review these points annually.

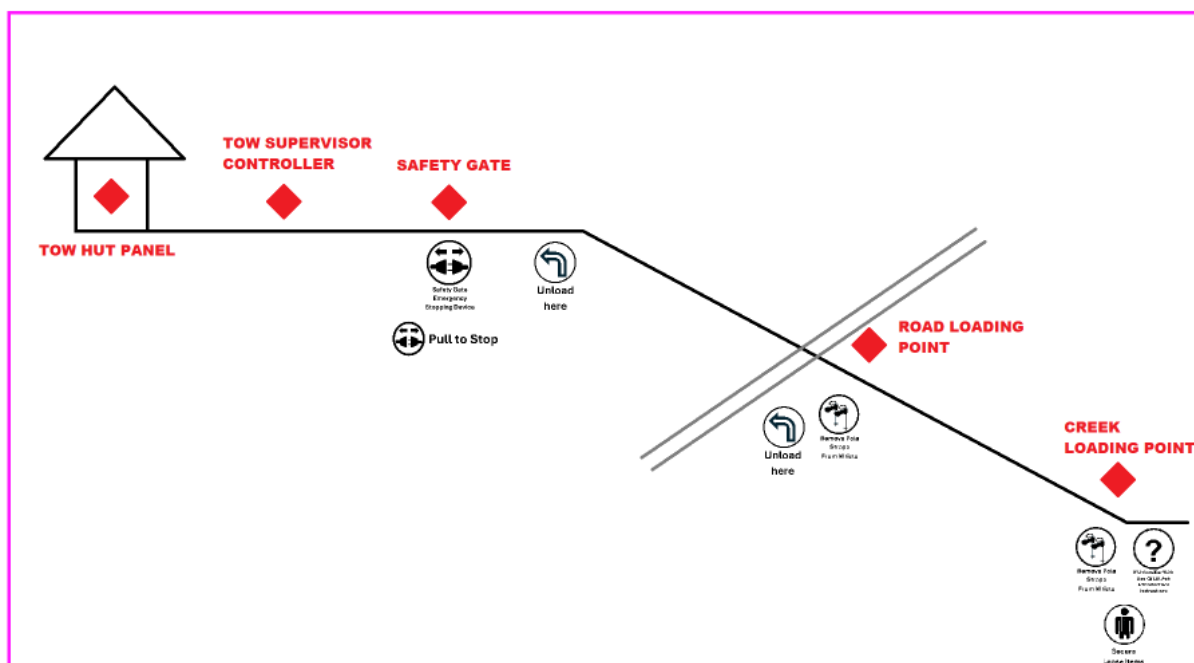
The Tow Leader is accountable for ensuring that the Designated Tow Operator Designated Tow Supervisors are rotated frequently to ensure everyone gets a fair go skiing the rope tow. With this said, these designated people should work with the people who hold equivalent training to regularly rotate whilst operating the tow without requiring the micromanagement of the Tow Leader.

Use the “BRC Rope Tow Logbook” to record daily, weekly and end of week safety checks. One sheet per week. This is found in the folder in the Tow Hut. Information from this report should be copied to complete the Tow Leader’s logbook.

Prior to first use for the week

- Film a full rotation of the rope (if it’s the first or last use of the season)
- Ensure orange conduit is out at the road to safely mark the location of the rope, and other slope hazards also marked with conduit as appropriate.
- Ensure that the legislative signage we’ve provided is displayed in their allocated locations as described in the *BRC Rope Tow SOPs*.
- Check the rope for any obvious signs of breakage, damage or significant wear
 - If any compromising signs are found, take photos and send them to Chief Warden (Matt Anderson) asap. Do not use the tow until advised otherwise.
 - Should no signs of damage, breakage or wear be found - so far so good!
- ***Find all required signage in the pink ski bag located in the workshop!!!***
- At the bottom “CREEK LOADING POINT”:
 - Loading signage (“remove your poles from your wrists”, “secure loose items”, “if unfamiliar ask for assistance with loading”)
- At the road “ROAD LOADING POINT”:
 - Place the star picket wrapped in the pink pool noodle just below the road
 - Attach the e-stop to the pink pool noodle
 - Place the loading signage (“remove your poles from your wrists”) facing uphill so people loading the tow can read it prior to loading
 - Place the unloading signage (“unload to your left”) facing downhill so people using the tow can read it prior to unloading
- At the top “SAFETY GATE”:
 - Set up e-stop by connecting the cord across the two points so that it will trigger the stop should someone ski through it
 - Place the unloading signage (“unload to your left”) facing downhill so people using the tow can read it prior to unloading

Please note, this is a change from what was originally mentioned at the Tow Briefing on the 10/07/25. Unloading is now only available to the left



Daily Safety Checks - before each day of use & after each use

For every day the tow operates, the following safety checks must be done prior to first use of the day. Remember to fill out the weekly log sheet for each day the tow is used.

- These procedures are found in the BRC Rope Tow SOPs document found at the Tow Hut

Logging competencies

Prior to the start of the week you will receive a list of all participant's current competency. In 2025, these competencies are self-determined, and in 2026 we are now holding a database of competencies to phase the self-determined system out.

Whenever the tow is in use, Tow Leader and Operators watch participants and assess and record each party member's ability to use the tow on either skis or snowboard. The categories of competency levels are as follows:

Trained Tow User: Can competently load and unload. Does not fall off the tow regularly (note, this was previously referred to as "Tow Trained Participant").

Tow Supervisor: Can competently mentor and supervise participants loading onto the tow and can capably operate e-stops. Can assist the Tow Leader with assessing participant competence.

Tow Operator: Can competently set up the tow including setting up top safety gate, loading stations and conduct safety checks. Can conduct rope tow safety briefing.

When assessing competencies, if in doubt, consult the other Tow Operators on your Winter Party. If still not sure, you're welcome to film a video of participants mounting, riding and dismounting the tow, to send to Bogong Bookings at the conclusion of your party.

These competencies and a full description of tasks for assessment are listed in the BRC Rope Tow Training Program document.

At the end of the week, please::

- A. Complete the list of participants on the Tow Leader report and the competency level that the Tow Leader and Tow Supervisor team believes is appropriate for each person. Give your Tow Leader Report to your Party Leader to send through to the Wardens Team.
- B. Take a photo of your report and email it to bookings within 48 hours of your winter party concluding (set a calendar reminder!)

These assessments of competency should be completed by the Tow Leader with the guidance of all Tow Operators.

End of the week

- Tow Leader should complete the Tow Leader's report
- Ensure the Tow Hut is locked, and all signage and external items have been put away.
- Ensure the Tow Hut logbook has been filled out!

Should any incidents occur, please refer to NOBS as normal incident reports and notifications are required.

End of season (rope comes in)

1. Take recording of the rope full rotation before pickup
2. Bring the rope in
 - a. The Wardens team will advise you if you need to do this. If you're unsure give them a call :)
3. Check the motor to flag any maintenance issues

Pro tips to remind your Tow Operators of :

- Testing of emergency stops can and should occur prior to engine start!
- Pink tools are tow tools

- Log any problems, issues or other things to note in the lookbooks provided
- Only carry out repairs to the motor and drivetrain if given *****explicit***** permission by the BCMG maintenance team / Wardens. If the tow system malfunctions contact the BCMG maintenance team for the next steps.

After your week

Submit your competency reports to the Party Leader who will submit them alongside the NOBS reports.

Please ensure that you have both submitted your paper report to your Party Leader, and email a photo of your report to bookings within 48 hours of the conclusion of your winter week.

If you are required to send through the full rotation video (first operating week of season), BCMG will contact you. You are only required to store the video for 30 days.

- If you would prefer to not store on your device and free up storage, upload [here](#).

Frequently Asked Questions

Can snowboarders use the tow? YES they're welcome to... try

Why do we film the rope? To monitor rope health.

Can anyone use the tow? NO, only participants of that winter week

Can I use the tow on my own? YES, provided that all skiing is within the green and blue zones marked on the map, and a Tow Supervisor is in place on each Loading and Unloading Point. When skiing on the Fringe Terrain (marked in red on the map), or the unbounded area (marked clear on the map), a minimum of 4 tow skiers must be adhered to, and Fringe Terrain skiers must observe the buddy system.

If an individual participant doesn't want to ride the tow do they still have to attend the briefing? YES.